policy serves the good of all, not just the wealthy or well-connected." These efforts were designed to align the IMF's image with the broader interests of working-class Greeks and to counter Syriza's narrative of the Fund as an elitist and oppressive institution.[103]

In addition to its public outreach, the IMF sought to placate Greece's populist government by pushing for more lenient debt-restructuring terms. This stance put the Fund at odds with European institutions, which maintained a hard-line approach to conditionality.[104] The IMF advocated for reducing the number of loan conditions imposed on Greece, with the total number of conditions dropping significantly, from forty-six in 2014 to just eight in 2015, coinciding with Syriza's ascent to power (Kentikelenis, Stubbs, and King 2016). However, the reduction in conditions may also reflect the winding down of the IMF's program in Greece, complicating efforts to attribute the shift solely to Syriza's influence.

Despite these efforts, the IMF faced an uphill battle in restoring its image among Greek citizens. While it managed to sustain Greece's engagement with the bailout program during much of Syriza's tenure, public sentiment toward the Fund remained overwhelmingly negative. The narrative of the IMF as an institution serving elites rather than ordinary people endured, with populist factions continuing to scapegoat it for Greece's economic struggles (Handlin, Kaya, and Günaydin 2023). This enduring tension underscores the challenges IOs face when navigating the intersection of populist resistance and the need for economic reform.

8.12 ICC and Various

The ICC, headquartered in The Hague, Netherlands, prosecutes individuals accused of crimes against humanity, genocide, war crimes, and crimes of aggression. Established in 1998 and operational since 2002, the ICC wields considerable authority, particularly over states that have ratified the Rome Statute, its founding document. Staffed by elite legal experts, judges, and investigators, the ICC is a highly constraining institution that enforces accountability for war crimes within its members' territories.

The ICC has faced significant pushback from African nations, which have been disproportionately represented in its prosecutions. This dynamic has sparked accusations of bias and infringements on state sovereignty,